

مركز الدراسات والبحوث
الاسلامية

ARTIST'S LABOUR FOR THE JEWISH PEOPLE

I. P. P. DEDICATION OF THE CHAGALL WINDOWS

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Marc Chagall's twelve stained glass windows were recently dedicated at a ceremony in the synagogue at the Hadassah-Hebrew University Medical Centre at Ein Keren.

The service was timed for noon so that the windows could be seen glowing in the full splendour of all their beauty, magnificently illuminated by the mid-day sun. The small unfinished synagogue was packed by a crowd who had come to hear Chagall himself speak. He greeted them in French, and then delivered an address in Yiddish.

He told them how in these windows, depicting the twelve tribes of Israel, he has attempted to express all the tragedy and heroism of the Jews through the ages, and how throughout his creation he had been influenced by the art of the ancient Semitic peoples.

Among those present were Mr and Mrs Arthur Greewald of New York, who had donated 10,000 dollars for one of the windows - that representing Benjamin.

Measures to protect the windows, which on the outside rise from ground level, are now being taken by the Centre's engineers. Chagall has also offered to design the Torah ark for the synagogue.

He will undertake other works for Israel if he has "the strength and inspiration".

Please acknowledge;

Photographs by WERNER BRAUN

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